

3과 한국어를 배워요

Chapter 3 — I study Korean

This chapter at a glance

주제	Topic 일상생활 — everyday life
어휘와 문법	Vocabulary & grammar 기본 형용사 / 기본 동사① / 동형-어요 / 명을·를 — basic adjectives and verbs · the polite -어요 ending · the object marker
활동	Activities 자신의 일상생활 말하기, 일상생활 소개 글 읽고 쓰기 — talking about your own day; reading and writing about daily life
문화와 정보	Culture & information 한국의 인사말 2 — Korean greetings, part 2

This is the chapter where Korean starts making sentences. Chapters 1 and 2 gave you **이에요** and **있어요** — two fixed endings. Here you learn **-어요**, the ending that turns almost any verb or adjective into a polite sentence, and **을/를**, which marks what the action is done to.

The dictionary form of every Korean verb and adjective ends in **-다**: **싸다**, **먹다**, **재미있다**. You never say the **-다** form out loud in conversation — it is the form you look up. To speak, you drop **-다** and add **-어요** or **-아요**. Learn both forms from the start, as a pair.

도입

Warm-up

Look at the pictures and talk about them

이 사람들이 무엇을 해요?

What are these people doing?

여러분은 오늘 무엇을 해요?

What are you doing today?

The original page shows three scenes: a student at a desk writing in a workbook with a tablet propped beside him; two office workers looking at a computer screen together; and a factory worker in a hard hat operating a machine on a production line. All three are answers to 무엇을 해요? — studying, working, working.

무엇을 해요? and the shorter 뭐 해요? mean the same thing. 뭐 is the everyday spoken form of 무엇, and you will hear it far more often. Both take 을 on the object, which is exactly the grammar point on page 37.

You can answer with just a verb: 공부해요 (I study), 일해요 (I work). A full sentence is not required, and leaving out 저는 is normal rather than lazy.

어휘와 문법 1

Vocabulary & grammar 1

그림을 보고 이야기해 보세요.

Look at the pictures and talk about them.

기본 형용사 — Basic adjectives, in opposite pairs

싸다 cheap	비싸다 expensive	많다 many, a lot	적다 few, not many
크다 big	작다 small	맛있다 tasty	맛없다 not tasty
어렵다 difficult	쉽다 easy	춥다 cold (weather)	덥다 hot (weather)
재미있다 fun, interesting	재미없다 boring	좋다 good	나쁘다 bad
예쁘다 pretty	바쁘다 busy	아프다 to hurt, be ill	배가 고프다 to be hungry

The book teaches these in pairs on purpose. 싸다/비싸다 and 맛있다/맛없다 are each other's opposites, so learning one gives you the other for free — and the pictures (a 10,000-won shoe beside a 500,000-won shoe) fix which is which.

맛있다 and 맛없다 are built from 맛 (taste) plus 있다/없다, the two verbs from chapter 2. Literally: 'taste exists' and 'taste does not exist'. 재미있다/재미없다 work the same way from 재미 (fun). You already know the parts.

배가 고프다 is literally 'the stomach is hungry' — 배 is the subject, which is why it takes 가. Korean says the body part is hungry rather than the person. 배가 아파요 (chapter 16) follows the same shape.

동형-어요

Verb/adjective + -어요

동사, 형용사 뒤에 붙어 문장의 끝(종결)을 나타내요.

Attaches to a verb or adjective to end a sentence politely.

가 빵이 맛있어요?
Is the bread good?

나 네, 맛있어요.
Yes, it's good.

예문 — Examples

가 사과가 싸요?
Are the apples cheap?

나 아니요, 사과가 비싸요.
No, the apples are expensive.

한국어는 쉬워요. 영어는 어려워요.

Korean is easy. English is difficult.

Which ending do I use?

-아요 after ㅏ or ㅑ in the last syllable
싸다 → 싸요 · 많다 → 많아요 · 좋다 → 좋아요

-어요 after any other vowel
맛있다 → 맛있어요 · ★예쁘다 → 예뻐요 · ★춥다 → 추워요

Look at the vowel in the last syllable of the stem. If it is ㅏ or ㅑ, add -아요; otherwise add -어요. 싸다 has ㅏ, so 싸 + 아요 contracts to 싸요. 많다 has ㅏ but ends in a consonant, so nothing contracts: 많아요.

The two starred forms are irregular and worth memorising now. 예쁘다 drops its ㅡ before the ending (예쁘 + 어요 → 예뻐요). 춥다 changes its final ㅍ to 우 (춥 + 어요 → 추워요) — the same change happens in 어렵다 → 어려워요 and 쉽다 → 쉬워요, both on this page.

-어요 makes statements and questions with the same words. 맛있어요. is 'it's good'; 맛있어요? is 'is it good?'. Only your intonation changes, exactly as with 이에요 in chapter 1.

연습 1 — 그림을 보고 친구에게 물어보세요.

가 의자가 많아요?
Are there a lot of chairs?

나 네, 의자가 많아요.
Yes, there are a lot of chairs.

가방, 작다
bag, small

책, 재미있다
book, interesting

과장님, 바쁘다
the section chief, busy

연습 2 — 친구하고 이야기해 보세요.

가 한국어 공부가 어려워요?
Is studying Korean difficult?

나 아니요, 재미있어요.

No, it's interesting.

한국어 공부가 어려워요?

Is studying Korean difficult?

한국 날씨가 추워요?

Is the weather in Korea cold?

한국 음식이 맛있어요?

Is Korean food tasty?

한국 드라마가 재미있어요?

Are Korean dramas interesting?

어휘와 문법 2

Vocabulary & grammar 2

무엇을 해요?

What are you doing?

기본 동사 — Basic verbs

고향 음식을 요리하다

to cook food from home

텔레비전을 보다

to watch television

빵을 먹다

to eat bread

일하다

to work

책을 읽다

to read a book

커피를 마시다

to drink coffee

친구를 만나다

to meet a friend

자다

to sleep

한국어를 공부하다

to study Korean

방을 청소하다

to clean the room

옷을 사다

to buy clothes

운동하다

to exercise

Notice that most of these are given as a whole phrase, not a bare verb: 책을 읽다, not just 읽다. That is deliberate — the object and its marker come as part of the expression, and learning them together means the 을/를 on page 37 is already familiar.

공부하다, 청소하다, 일하다, 운동하다 all end in 하다 (to do). Korean makes verbs by putting 하다 after a noun: 공부 (study) + 하다, 청소 (cleaning) + 하다. Every one of them conjugates to 해요, so learning one gives you all of them.

자다 and 일하다 take no object, which is why they appear here without 을/를. Not every verb needs something to act on — you sleep, you work, and that is the whole sentence.

명을/를

Noun + 을/를 — the object marker

명사에 붙어 문장에서 목적어임을 나타낼 때 사용해요.

Attaches to a noun to mark it as the object of the sentence.

가 지금 뭐 해요?
What are you doing now?

나 책을 읽어요.
I'm reading a book.

예문 — Examples

가 무엇을 마셔요?
What are you drinking?

나 주스를 마셔요.
I'm drinking juice.

저는 텔레비전을 봐요. 성민 씨는 한국어를 공부해요.

I watch television. Seong-min studies Korean.

Which marker do I use?

을 after a final consonant (받침)
책 → 책을 · 옷 → 옷을

를 after a vowel
사과 → 사과를 · 영화 → 영화를

The same sound rule again, for the third time: consonant takes 을, vowel takes 를. You have now met 이/가, 은/는 and 을/를, and all three split on exactly the same question — does the word end in a 받침?

이/가 marks who or what does the action; 을/를 marks what the action is done to. 제이슨 씨가 빵을 먹어요 — Jason (subject) eats bread (object). Swap the markers and you have changed who is eating whom.

Word order is subject, then object, then verb — the verb always comes last. English puts the verb in the middle. Because the markers show which noun is which, Korean can move them around and still be clear; the verb staying last is the part that does not change.

연습 1 — 이 사람은 뭐 해요? 이야기해 보세요.

가 슬기는 지금 뭐 해요?
What is Seul-gi doing now?

나 슬기는 게임을 해요.
Seul-gi is playing a game.

제이슨, 빵을 먹다
Jason, eat bread

안젤라, 텔레비전을 보다
Angela, watch television

이링, 일하다
Yiling, work

연습 2 — 여러분은 오늘 뭐 해요? 그 일이 어때요?

저는 오늘 책을 읽어요. 책이 재미있어요.

Today I'm reading a book. The book is interesting.

말하기와 듣기

Speaking & listening

교실에서 제이슨 씨와 후엔 씨가 이야기해요.

Jason and Huyen are talking in the classroom.

제이슨 후엔 씨, 오늘 뭐 해요?

Huyen, what are you doing today?

후엔 친구를 만나요. 제이슨 씨는 뭐 해요?

I'm meeting a friend. What about you, Jason?

제이슨 저는 한국 영화를 봐요. 한국 영화가 재미있어요.

I'm watching a Korean film. Korean films are interesting.

Swap in these pairs

친구를 만나다 | 한국 영화를 보다, 한국 영화를 재미있어요 친구를 만나다, 커피를 마시다

meet a friend | watch a Korean film, Korean films are interesting meet a friend, drink coffee

보다 conjugates to 봐요, not 보어요: the stem vowel ㅓ takes -아요 and then contracts. 마시다 $\rightarrow$ 마셔요 and 만나다 $\rightarrow$ 만나요 contract the same way. These are the everyday forms, so say them aloud until they stop needing thought.

Huyen answers 친구를 만나요 without saying 저는. Korean drops the subject whenever it is obvious, and here the question already named her. Adding 저는 is not wrong, but leaving it out is what a fluent speaker does.

듣기 — 라흐만 씨와 이링 씨가 이야기해요

1) 이링 씨는 오늘 뭐 해요?

What is Yiling doing today?

2) 숙제가 (많아요 / 적어요).

The homework is (a lot / not much).

3) 숙제가 (재미있어요 / 재미없어요).

The homework is (interesting / boring).

숙제 (homework) is new. Questions 2 and 3 give you both options in Korean, so you only need to hear which one Yiling says — listen for 많아요 or 적어요 at the end, not for every word in between.

읽기와 쓰기

Reading & writing

다음은 친구들의 이야기예요. 잘 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

This is a story about the classmates. Read it and answer the questions.

교실에 학생들이 있어요.

There are students in the classroom.

후엔 씨가 책을 읽어요. 책이 재미있어요.

Huyen is reading a book. The book is interesting.

안젤라 씨가 전화해요.

Angela is making a phone call.

라민 씨가 물을 마셔요.

Ramin is drinking water.

라흐만 씨가 빵을 먹어요. 빵이 맛있어요.

Rahman is eating bread. The bread is good.

Questions

1) 후엔 씨가 어디에 있어요?

→ 교실에 있어요

2) 안젤라 씨가 뭐 해요?

→ 전화해요

3) 빵이 맛있어요?

→ 네, 맛있어요

Read the passage for its pattern: every sentence is either someone-이/가 something-을/를 verb-어요, or something-이/가 adjective-어요. That is the whole chapter in seven lines.

학생들이 지금 뭐 해요? 써 보세요.

고천 씨가 유튜브를 _____

Gao Chen is _____ YouTube → 봐요

유튜브가 _____

YouTube is _____ → 재미있어요

잠시드 씨가 이야기 _____

Jamshid is _____ → 해요

이링 씨가 커피를 _____

Yiling is _____ coffee → 마셔요

제이슨 씨가 사과를 _____

Jason is _____ an apple → 먹어요

사과가 _____

The apple is _____ → 맛있어요

단어장 — New words

학생들

students

유튜브

YouTube

학생들 is 학생 (student) plus 들, which marks a plural. Korean usually leaves plurality to context — 학생이 있어요 can mean one student or many — so 들 appears only when the writer wants to be explicit.

문화와 정보 — 한국의 인사말 2

Culture & information — Korean greetings 2

한국 사람들은 다른 사람에게 고마울 때, '고맙습니다', '감사합니다'라고 말해요.

When Koreans are grateful to someone, they say 고맙습니다 or 감사합니다.

그리고 다른 사람에게 사과할 때, '죄송합니다', '미안합니다'라고 말해요.

And when they apologise, they say 죄송합니다 or 미안합니다.

이 말들은 비슷한 뜻이에요.

These expressions mean much the same thing.

그러나 '미안합니다'는 나이가 많은 사람이나 윗사람에게 잘 쓰지 않아요. '죄송합니다'가 더 좋아요.

But 미안합니다 is not much used to someone older or senior to you. 죄송합니다 is better.

고마울 때 어떻게 인사해요? — Thanking someone

고맙습니다

thank you — native Korean word

감사합니다

thank you — from Sino-Korean, slightly more formal

사과할 때 어떻게 말해요? — Apologising

죄송합니다

I'm sorry — safe with anyone

미안합니다

I'm sorry — not to elders or superiors

The distinction is worth taking seriously. 죄송합니다 works in every situation, so if you learn only one, learn that one. Saying 미안합니다 to your boss or to an older neighbour sounds too casual for the apology to land.

Both pairs come in a -습니다 form, which is more formal than the -어요 you learned this chapter. You will meet the full -습니다 style later; for now, treat these four as fixed expressions and use them as they are.

Questions

1) 한국 사람은 언제 '고맙습니다'를 말해요? '미안합니다'와 비슷한 인사말은 뭐예요? 여러분 나라 말로 '고맙습니다', '미안합니다'는

When do Koreans say 고맙습니다?

Which expression is close in meaning to 미안합니다? How do you say them in your own language?

발음 · 배운 어휘 확인

Pronunciation · Vocabulary checklist

발음 — Listen and repeat

읽어요	[일거요] il-geo-yo
재미있어요	[재미이썬요] jae-mi-i-sseo-yo
많아요	[마나요] ma-na-yo

읽다 is written with two final consonants (ㄷ). Before a vowel only the second one moves across, giving [일거요] — the ㄷ stays put and the ㄱ links. This is the same 연음 as 이름이 → [이르미] in chapter 1, just with a doubled 받침.

많아요 loses its ㅎ entirely: [마나요]. A ㅎ between voiced sounds is very often dropped in speech, which is why 좋아요 is said [조아요]. The spelling never changes, only the sound.

연습 — Listen and practise

- 가** 뭐 해요?
What are you doing?
- 나** 한국어 책을 읽어요.
I'm reading a Korean book.
- 가** 영화가 재미있어요?
Is the film interesting?
- 나** 네, 재미있어요.
Yes, it's interesting.
- 가** 사과가 많아요?
Are there a lot of apples?
- 나** 아니요, 사과가 적어요.
No, there aren't many.

배운 어휘 확인 — Vocabulary checklist

싸다 cheap	비싸다 expensive	많다 many	적다 few
크다 big	작다 small	맛있다 tasty	맛없다 not tasty
어렵다 difficult	쉽다 easy	춥다 cold	덥다 hot
재미있다 fun	재미없다 boring	좋다 good	나쁘다 bad
예쁘다 pretty	바쁘다 busy	아프다 to be ill	배가 고프다 to be hungry
고향 음식을 요리하다 cook food from home	책을 읽다 read a book	한국어를 공부하다 study Korean	텔레비전을 보다 watch television

커피를 마시다

drink coffee

옷을 사다

buy clothes

학생들

students

방을 청소하다

clean the room

일하다

work

유튜브

YouTube

빵을 먹다

eat bread

자다

sleep

친구를 만나다

meet a friend

운동하다

exercise